SLEEP 10

Magnesium

Dietary mineral, taken as salts such as bisglycinate or L-threonate; sulfate form is an injectable drug



CLASS	STUDIED FOR	HUMAN EVIDENCE	US STATUS
Mineral	Sleep, insomnia	Small RCTs; low certainty	Dietary supplement · not a sleep drug

STUDIED FOR

Insomnia	Poor sleep	Magnesium deficiency
HUMAN	HUMAN	HUMAN

Sleep evidence is low certainty. A 2026 review of 12 trials found inconsistent results and said the evidence does not support routine use for insomnia.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Magnesium → NMDA receptors → GABA signaling → Sleep

- **Blocks NMDA receptors,** the reasoning given in trial papers
- **Supports GABA signaling,** a brain system involved in sleep
- These are proposed reasons for study, **not trial results**
- **In people,** the sleep mechanism is not established

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

FDA APPROVED
LEVEL 5 OF 5

- Injection FDA approved, for other uses
- Sleep RCTs of 46 to 155 people, weeks long
- Reviews: low to very low certainty

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Long-term use for sleep
- Best salt for sleep
- Dose for sleep in people
- Side-effect rates in sleep use

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE	ROUTES STUDIED
Not established in people	By mouth (sleep trials); injection for approved uses
PHARMACOKINETICS	**SOLD AS**
Excreted by the kidneys (injection label)	Dietary supplement; Rx injection (other uses)
MONITORED IN TRIALS	**SPORT (WADA)**
Insomnia scores, sleep logs, ring-based sleep scores	Not on the 2026 list

REGULATORY

FDA	Not approved for sleep; sold as a supplement
FDA	Sulfate injection approved for other uses
WADA	Not on the 2026 list

REFERENCES

1. Lopresti et al., J Diet Suppl, magnesium for sleep (systematic review), Aug 2026
2. Mah and Pitre, BMC Complement Med Ther, magnesium for insomnia (meta-analysis), Apr 2021
3. FDA, Magnesium Sulfate Injection label (DailyMed), Feb 2026

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